

Two French priests, Father Mary Cressonnier, 59, of Beauvais, and Father Pierre Poncet, 36, of Besancon, members of the Foreign Missions Society of Paris (Societe des Missions Etrangeres de Paris), were ambushed and shot to death by Viet Cong gunmen as they drove through the Phu Cam area on February 25. A Catholic layman, riding with them, was shot and left lying in a ditch by the side of the road, but survived.

Two other French priests, Father Urbain, 52, and Father Guy, 48, of the Benedictine Monastery at Thien An, six kilometers south of Hue, were seized as they fled with members of the order and refugees who had sought shelter there, after North Vietnamese forces seized the Monastery and converted it into a command post during their retreat from Hue. The two priests were taken with more than four hundred others to the area of the Imperial tombs, about three kilometers from the monastery, and executed. Father Urbain was bound hand and foot and buried alive with ten others in a common grave. Father Guy was stripped of his robes, forced to kneel, and shot through the head.

Three Korean civilians, Kang Bok Nam, Ok Yoo Il, and Pak Won Jo, employed by an engineering and construction firm in Hue, and a Chinese civilian, Huan Wei, representing a Hong Kong clothing firm, were arrested and shot. Their bodies were found

a month later with those of a number of South Vietnamese civilians executed by the Viet Cong and dumped into several mass graves in an area on the north side of Hue known as "the Mulberry Fields." ^{19/}

The Viet Cong showed relentless efficiency in many cases. On February 9, several armed cadre entered the house of Major Tu Ton Khan, 35, Chief of the Rural Development Service, in Hue. They seized Mrs. Khan, mother of six young children, demanded to know where her husband was, and informed her they would burn the house down unless she called him to present himself immediately. Having no choice, Mrs. Khan called her husband, who came down from the attic where he was hiding with two of his rural development workers. The Communists confiscated Major Khan's money and belongings, tied him up with a rope, and led him away. His body was found in the Gia Hoi High School yard February 28 with arms still bound and with up to 200 bullet holes in it. Identification was possible thanks to papers found on the body. ^{20/}

^{19/} Report of Lt. Xien, Van Thanh Infantry Training Center, to G-5, Headquarters, 1st Infantry Division, ARVN, March 14, 1968. Lt. Chung, Republic of Korea Forces in Viet-Nam, Tae Kwan Do Instructor at the Training Center, assisted Lt. Xien in the identification of the Korean civilians.

^{20/} Files of National Police, Headquarters, Thua Thien Province. A brief summary is contained in Vu Cuong-Sat cua Viet-Cong tai Co-Do Hue, p. 7, cited earlier.

Mr. Huong, a former soldier living with his wife and six children in the village of Bao Vinh on the outskirts of Hue, was seized by a group of Viet Cong who entered his house on the third day of the occupation, denounced him as a former soldier, who must therefore "pay for his crimes against the people," and led him to a place where a number of others from the village were held captive. Although Huong's arms were bound behind his back, he managed to slip away, but was recaptured a few hundred meters from the place. The Viet Cong brought him back, cut off his feet in the presence of the other captives, and then as he writhed on the ground screaming in agony, dispatched him with one bullet from a pistol fired into his mouth. ^{21/}

Nha Ca, in her book, A Mourning Turban for Hue, tells of two students executed by the Viet Cong in the orchard of her uncle without benefit of a "trial" (page 239); of another student forced to stand in a hole while a Viet Cong action squad leader, a former classmate, condemned him to death (pages 365-66); and of the summary execution of two other young men found hiding in a cellar -- they were charged with "attempting to avoid the Liberation

^{21/} Nhu Ha, "With the 'Year of the Dog' Coming, Hue Still Weeps for Tet of the 'Year of the Monkey'," daily Chinh Luan (Political Commentator), Part 3 of three-part series, February 1, 1970, p. 7. The incident was described to the victim's wife by a neighbor who witnessed the execution.

Army" (page 147). Some of the civilian captives were taken to the Citadel gate, tied up and left there to be killed by artillery fire and strafing attacks (pages 372-73).

In a number of instances recorded in city and provincial police files citizens of Hue were executed out of whim and caprice. "A man was killed for having refused to turn in his radio receiver," reports Lt. Col. Ngo Nhu Bich in the monograph Communist Carnage in Hue (page 12). "A school boy was shot dead for having missed a political meeting Families which did not obey Communist orders were accused of 'indifference toward the Revolution' and their chief slain on the spot."

Mr. Ngo Ba Nhuan, 59, representative of an insurance company, residing with his family at Huynh Thuc Khang Street in downtown Hue, was taken by the Viet Cong to the Dong Xuan Lau theater (a popular execution spot during the occupation) and shot when his family were slow to open their front door when the Communists knocked. Nhuan was condemned and executed as a "recalcitrant." 22/

Mr. Hoang Truong Linh, 50, a teacher, married, father of nine, living in the village of Duong Xuan Thuong on the right bank

22/ Communist Carnage, p. 16.

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of the Perfume River west of the railway bridge was arrested by Viet Cong on a charge of having a son in the army. Linh's body was discovered in March 1968 in a common grave with seven other execution victims. All had been buried alive.^{23/}

The American reporter Don Oberdorfer, who conducted extensive talks with friends and relatives of Communist execution victims in Hue in the autumn of 1969, reports one incident which was related to him by witnesses:

An old man who protested in the arrest of his daughter was trussed up and marched off, and his son-in-law, who protested threats against the family, was also bound up. When the Viet Cong soldiers began to slap the son-in-law, the old man declared, "If that's the kind of revolution you proclaim, nobody wants it." The soldiers shot both father and son-in-law on the spot, but let the daughter free.^{24/}

^{23/} Communist Carnage, p. 14.

^{24/} Don Oberdorfer, "Hue: Deliberate Slaughter," The Washington Post, December 7, 1969.

MASS GRAVES AND EXECUTION SITES

(WINTER-SPRING 1968)

As ARVN and United States forces regained areas of the city in heavy fighting during the month of February 1968, citizens of Hue came forward with stories of massive abductions and assassinations of government officials, civil servants, policemen, captive soldiers, and private citizens during the Communist occupation. With the expulsion of the final battered remnants of the North Vietnamese Army and National Liberation Front forces from the Citadel on February 25 and the restoration of security throughout the city, a major effort was got under way to locate and recover the bodies of Hue citizens executed by the Communist forces and political cadre.

The understaffed public health services ^{25/} and searching relatives and friends concentrated their efforts first on known execution sites. One of these was the yard of the Gia Hoi High

^{25/} Bernard Weinraub reported in a special dispatch from Hue to The New York Times on February 28 that only 300 of the city's former 2,000 civil servants were at work. He added: "The bodies of some of the missing civil servants were reported found today in a mass grave, about 500 yards from the Citadel wall" "Death Holds Shattered City of Hue in a Quiet Agony," The New York Times, March 1, 1968.

School, which had been a headquarters and command post of the People's Revolutionary Party during the four-week Communist occupation. The two-story modern school building, located in a semi-rural neighborhood of Hue's District II about one-half kilometer north of the Dong Ba Gate, had also been used as a detention and interrogation center and "People's Court." In the last week of February and the first half of March, twenty-two mass graves containing the bodies of 396 men, 22 youths under age of 20, two women and five young girls were unearthed in the school yard.

Across the road, about 300 meters away in a plowed field behind the Tang Quang Tu Pagoda, the bodies of 299 others -- 295 men, one woman, and three youths -- were uncovered in thirteen mass graves, during the same period.

Eight more mass graves were discovered on March 7 near a road intersection in the marshy area at the upper edge of District II known locally as Bai Dau, or "the Mulberry Field." The bodies of 96 men -- including three Korean and one Chinese civilians -- and eight youths were discovered here.^{26/}

^{26/} Report dated March 22, 1968 from Tong Van Ba, Chief of Information Section, Hue, District II, to Chief, Vietnamese Information Service, Hue-Thua Thien.

At each of these locations in District II, the victims were found almost invariably with wire or rope bindings still on the arms or legs. Most of the victims had been executed by pistol or automatic weapons fire (all of those found at "the Mulberry Field" had been shot through the head), but there was evidence that many at the High School and in the field behind the Pagoda had been killed by bludgeoning or had been buried alive. Some bodies showed damage to the cranium other than by gunfire. Some were found in their graves bound up singly or in groups, without any sign of external wounds, and in contorted postures indicating death by asphyxiation. A number of the bodies had been mutilated, before or after death.

A report prepared in the headquarters of the National Police, Thua Thien Province, for announcement over Radio Hue, listed the names and occupations of 200 of the victims found at the three major locations in the Gia Hoi area (District II). ^{27/}

This list is given

^{27/} "List of the Military, Civil Servants, Cadres and Civilians Murdered by the VC in Recent Conflicts," report dated April 6, 1968, prepared by Lt. Lien Thanh for Thua Thien National Police Chief, with transmittal slip to Manager of Radio Hue.

This list is summarized as follows:

Police -- including three visiting policemen from other cities, two village security policemen, and one policewoman	54
Civil servants -- including public works, post telephone, and telegraph, treasury section, agricultural service, engineers, drivers, and other personnel, two of whom were retired	29
Military personnel	27
Students and Youth League members	23
Provincial officials, village and hamlet chiefs, members of village councils	13
Rural Development Service (RD cadre)	10
Ward, community, and inter-family group chiefs	6
Teachers	2
Homeguard militiamen (Popular Force)	1
Private sector -- including a clerk, secretary, physician, Air Vietnam employee, building contractor, shoemaker, ferryboatman, sampan man, two cyclo drivers, two electricians, two welders, two housewives, four merchants, and fifteen persons listed simply as "civilians," with no occupation given	<u>35</u>
Total	200

As security was extended to the outlying districts outside the city of Hue during the month of March 1968, additional mass graves of Communist execution victims were located. Between March 1 and April 8, 1968, graves containing the bodies of more than nine hundred persons put to death by the Communist military forces and political action teams were found in thirteen localities within a radius of eight kilometers west, south and east of the city.

A list of these localities, prepared from records at the National Police Headquarters, Thua Thien Province, the Health, Social Welfare, and Refugee Relief Service, Thua Thien, and the Combined Interrogation Center in Hue follows:

Graves containing the bodies of 25 villagers beheaded by the Communists in the first days of the occupation were found at Xa Huong Long, just west of the Citadel wall.

An estimated fifty bodies were recovered from two graves at the foot of the An Ninh Ha bridge, approximately one and one-half kilometers west of the Citadel, on the right bank of the Sau River. Many of the victims found here had been buried alive.

An estimated 100 victims were found in an unlisted number of graves in the Cho Thong area, farther along the Sau River, approximately 2 kilometers west of the city.

On the lower bank of the Perfume River, two kilometers west of District III, a grave containing nine victims who had been invited to a "political meeting" was found March 10 in the yard of the Van Chi School, in the village of Duong Xuan Ha.

Another grave containing the bodies of eight was found about the same time in the neighboring village of Duong Xuan Thuong.

Near Long Tho Village, three kilometers west of the railroad bridge, approximately thirty bodies were found in the first week of March.

On March 8, villagers at Ap Dong Gi Tay, six kilometers east of Hue, reported finding the bodies of seventy-five people from a neighboring village whom the Communist forces had taken into a rice paddy between the two villages and killed during their retreat.

On March 14, a unit of the ARVN 21st Ranger Battalion on a sweep along the coastal strip approximately 10 kilometers east of the city reported finding some twenty-five shallow graves containing an estimated 100 bodies, the heads and limbs of some of which could be seen protruding from the sand.

Between March 19 and 23, extensive exhumations took place in the area of the Imperial Tombs 3-4 kilometers south of the city. The Communists executed an estimated 450 citizens of

Hue and nearby rural communities at this spot as they withdrew from the city in the last days of February.

Twenty graves containing the bodies of 201 victims were found in the vicinity of the tombs of the Emperors Tu Duc and Dong Khanh.

An additional 250 bodies were found in shallow, scooped out holes on a nearby slope leading down to a great bend in the Perfume River from the popular scenic overlook known as Thien Ham.

Many of the victims at these two sites were people from villages and hamlets in the area who had sought refuge in the nearby hilltop monastery of Thien An during the early days of the fighting and then had fled in varying sized-groups after the NVA and NLF forces seized the monastery and converted it into a command post and firing position. Witnesses and survivors reported that whole groups of these fleeing refugees were waylaid by Communist patrols on the roads and trails leading down the mountain from Thien An, and various persons picked out for execution. In addition to Fathers Guy and Urbain, whose deaths were described earlier, the victims included a number of village and hamlet chiefs and deputy chiefs and their wives, many of the young religious students (juvenistes) and workers from the

- 20 -

monastery, and a number of policemen, minor village functionaries, local peasants, schoolteachers, and others picked up in the surrounding countryside and from among the Catholics of the Phu Cam area.^{28/}

Mr. Ho Van Minh of the Health, Social Welfare, and Refugee Relief Service, Hue-Thua Thien, participated in the recovery of the bodies in the Imperial Tombs and Thien Ham areas and talked with villagers who had witnessed the executions. He reported that at least fifty of the victims were women, some of whom were in pregnancy. Some of the victims had been shot with automatic weapons fire. Others had been clubbed unconscious and buried where they fell. Some had been lashed together in clusters of 10-15, pushed into hastily dug holes, and interred alive. Many of the executions were carried out at night.^{29/}

In the latter half of March 1968, more graves containing the bodies of 45-50 execution victims were uncovered in the vicinity of Emperor Khai Dinh's tomb, about six and one-half kilometers due south of Hue. Among the victims identified here also were villagers, including two hamlet chiefs and their wives, who had

^{28/} Testimony of Dom Thomas, Father Superior of Thien An, November 25, 1968.

^{29/} Interview with Paul Kennel, World Relief Commission, at Hue, April 10, 1968.

been among the 4,000 refugees who had sought shelter in the Thien An Monastery and then fled after the Communist forces occupied it and converted it to an artillery position. These graves were found in soft earth in a meadow near the roadside at a point approximately 1-1/2 kilometer southeast of the monastery.

On April 2, 1968, a Thua Thien farmer searching for the remains of his son, known to have been taken away and executed by the Communists, noticed a patch of freshly dug earth at the wooded edge of a potato field behind a small country pagoda two kilometers south of Hue and notified an ARVN Engineer unit nearby. It was thus that the bound and shot bodies of Dr. and Mrs. Krainick, Dr. Discher, and Dr. Altekoeester of the West German medical team at Hue University were found. They were in a single grave about 2-1/2 kilometers from the faculty apartments where they had been arrested by the VC eight weeks before.

On April 8, Thua Thien police and health authorities operating on the basis of reports from people at the village of Lang Xa Con, three kilometers due east of the An Cuu market, uncovered four graves containing the bodies of Senator Tran Dien and nineteen others. They were from the group of 80-100 seized on February 8

at the Redemptorist Church in Hue. The victims, including two women, had been bound and shot.

In addition to the execution victims found in mass graves in the four localities noted inside the City of Hue (District II) and those found in these thirteen other localities within an eight-kilometer radius of the city up to April 15, 1968, the bodies of more than fifty were recovered by searching relatives from individual graves in which they were dumped by the Communists following on-the-spot executions. Records in the statistical section of the Health, Social Welfare, and Refugee Relief Service, Thua Thien Province, list fifty-three names in this category. However, public health officials believe that many more bodies of individual execution victims were interred by relatives during the period of the Communist occupation or discovered in the course of the widespread family searches that took place throughout the surrounding countryside in the months following the Communist withdrawal and were not reported.

In many instances bodies of victims were found, one or two to a grave, and were not, or could not be, identified because of decomposition, disfigurement owing to clubbing or the damaging effect of bullets fired through the face or back of the head, and absence of identifiable clothing, papers or personal effects.

A typical case was described by Stewart Harris, correspondent for The Times of London, who visited Hue and areas around the city in mid-March 1968. Mr. Harris tells of going with a Vietnamese-speaking Australian Warrant Officer, an advisor to the South Vietnamese forces, to view a grave near a village in the Nam Hoa valley several kilometers south of Hue.

"We were standing on the sloping sides of a recently dug hole," he writes. "In the bottom were rush mats over sheets of plastic. Mr. Ostara drew them back, revealing the bodies of two Vietnamese with their arms tied behind their backs just above the elbows. They had been shot through the back of their heads.

"The day before, 27 women from the village walked out three miles carrying mattocks to dig for their missing husbands and sons, having heard about this patch of disturbed earth near the roadside. Mr. Ostara was with them as they worked. They left the unrecognized bodies for others to look at." 30/

There is no record at the Nam Hoa District Office that these two victims were even identified.

A report signed by Lt. Col. Doan Cong Lap, Chief, Thua Thien Police Service, on April 9, 1968, stated that, as of that date:

30/ Stewart Harris, "Mass Execution Policy Confirmed in Newly Discovered Hue Graves," The Times (London), March 25, 1968.

"About 1,000 people taken away from Hue City and vicinity and killed by the Viet Cong have been found in graves along their [the Viet Cong's] route of withdrawal." 31/

31/ Tu Tham-Sat Cua Viet-Cong Tai Hue Va Thua Thien Tet Mau-Thau 1968 (Viet Cong Massacre at Hue and in Thua Thien Province in the 1968 Tet Year of the Monkey Offensive), p. 1. This four-page typewritten report, with hand-drawn charts of grave locations attached, lists the names of an additional 75 execution victims recovered from collective graves in and near Hue. They include Professor Pham Dinh Bach of the University of Hue, a member of the Central Executive Committee of the Vietnamese Nationalist Party (VNQDD) and six other persons prominent in the activities of this party, including Mrs. Nguyen Thi Hoang.

MASS GRAVES AND EXECUTION SITES (SPRING 1969)

Renewed searches undertaken by citizens' committees and local authorities in March and April of 1969 uncovered 47 additional mass graves at five locations in the Huong Thuy and Phu Thu Districts east of the city of Hue. Between March 25 and April 28, 1969, the bodies of 809 victims of the Communist execution squads were exhumed. Of these, 232 were identified and claimed by relatives who took them away for private burial. The remaining 577 were placed in coffins and reinterred by the Thua Thien provincial government in public memorial services in burial parks prepared for them on the outskirts of Hue.

Six graves were uncovered in a field near the village of Xuan Hoa, Huong Thuy District, in the rice paddy country three kilometers due east of Hue. They yielded 78 bodies. These graves were no more than 1,000 meters from the place where the bodies of Senator Dien and other victims from the Redemptorist Church were found near the village of Lang Xa Con a year before.

Thirteen graves containing the bodies of 104 execution victims were found near the village of Le Xa Tay, 6-1/2 kilometers east of Hue, in a field about 100 meters from the canal path that leads northward from the Loi Nong River to the sea. These graves too

were only a few hundred meters from the area between the villages of Dong Gi Tay and Tay Ho where the bodies of 75 persons taken from among 200 hostages and shot by the VC had been discovered in March 1968.

A total of 28 graves containing the bodies of 627 execution victims were uncovered in three areas of the sandy coastal strip that begins at a point about 8-1/2 kilometers northeast of Hue and extends along the coast in a southeasterly direction for approximately 12 kilometers. This barren stretch of low, rolling sand dunes dotted with patches of stubble grass runs along the shore of the narrow Thuy Tu Lagoon that separates Thua Thien Province from Vinh Loc Island and the South China Sea. It has long been an infiltration route for the Viet Cong and was one of their principal routes of approach and withdrawal during their 1968 Tet offensive against Hue.

Bodies were recovered from multiple mass graves in the following localities:

-- Near the villages of Xuan O and Dien Dai in the Phu Xuan Township near the head of the sandstrip, approximately 8 kilometers east northeast of Hue -- 15 graves, 399 bodies.

-- Farther along the sand strip at a point near the village of Le Xa Dong, 10 kilometers due east of Hue -- one grave,

40 bodies.

-- Still farther down this strip in the neighborhood of the village of Vinh Lau, 12 kilometers due east of Hue -- 12 graves, 248 bodies.

The mass graves uncovered in this sandy wasteland in the spring of 1969 consisted of shallow trenches, approximately 1 meter wide, 1 meter deep, and 15-20 meters long, containing in most cases between twenty and thirty bodies. The large grave uncovered near Le Xa Dong on April 28 yielded up forty bodies, including several women and young girls.

Identification of the victims, lying in these shallow trenches for more than a year and oftentimes found dumped or fallen one on top of another, was difficult and in most cases impossible. But the contorted positions, trussed arms, neck halters, bamboo ropes, and crushed skulls, and the empty bullet casings from the AK-47 assault rifle found in and around the trenches indicated the manner of their deaths. Most of the victims died by shooting, but the heavy incidence of skull damage among the corpses recovered from the twelve graves at Vinh Lau suggested death by bludgeoning of many at this location. ^{32/}

^{32/} Monthly report, Public Safety Division, Phu Tu Subsector, March 1969.

In a few instances there was evidence that prisoners were beaten to death. Robert G. Kaiser, in a dispatch from Hue to The Washington Post on May 5, reported: "Every principal bone of one skeleton found two weeks ago was broken." On the other hand, he stated: "Some of the bodies showed no signs of any injury and presumably buried alive." 33/

A graphic picture of the Spring 1969 exhumation of execution victims in the sand flats east of Hue was given by the American Pulitzer-Prize winning journalist-photographer Horst Faas in a dispatch to the Associated Press on April 12. Faas described the scene as hundreds of men and women from Hue and nearby villages squatted in the middle of the desolate sand flat at Dien Dai near several burial trenches that had already been emptied and waited anxiously for the opening of still another:

The trench to be excavated is clearly recognizable: a long, three foot wide depression overgrown with bright green grass standing out amid the coarse scrub of the dunes.

Women distribute surgical gloves and face masks. From a bottle they pour alcohol over the gauze.

Eight grave-diggers, mostly barefoot and wearing shorts, begin to open the length of the trench.

Three feet down, they find the corpses.

33/ The Washington Post, May 5, 1969, p. 1.

stacked against each other in a straight line. With small shovels, sand is removed right and left of the line.

With their hands, the workers lift the bodies from the graves onto plastic sheets.

The grave-diggers lift the skull of every body out first, gently brushing away the sand.

Two men check the dental structure and the length and color of the hair. They report the results through their facemasks to four young men and girls registering all identifications in pads. A number for future identifications is put on each skull.

One unidentified victim is found to have a plastic image of Buddha on a silver chain clenched between the teeth.

The torsos of the corpses, with arms and legs huddled in the crouching, kneeling position in which the victims were killed, are lifted out by grave-diggers.

In monotonous voices, officials announce to the waiting men and women what they find as they rip clothing apart, search pockets for identification papers and military tags.

Militiaman Nguyen My, who has stood beside the trench for two hours, suddenly falls to his knees, howling like a wounded animal. Then his voice becomes a whimper and he touches a piece of uniform with the name tag of his brother Nguyen Duc. With trembling hands he pulls his dead brother's picture from his wallet, showing it around.

The brother's remains are wrapped in a plastic sheet. The package looks like the mummy of a child.

Two black-clad militiamen carry the corpse away on a makeshift bamboo stretcher. Soldier Nguyen My, crying, stumbles behind.

The day before he had found his other brother, Nguyen Doan, in another mass grave. All three had been captured during the Tet offensive. Only Nguyen My escaped.

As the hot day wears on, almost every yard of trench yields a body.

The grave-diggers run short of plastic sheets and bodies are laid out in the sand.

A woman, digging with her fingers through a heap of bones, shrieks and collapses, tears streaming down her face. She wails and beats her hands on the ground, rocking back and forth. After her husband's body is wrapped, she embraces the bundle. Other women drag her away and support her as she follows the stretcher-bearers.

Some of the women return after burying one relative, looking for others. One peasant woman found her husband and two sons within two days in different execution trenches.

Such scenes are repeated along the road, to which the bodies are carried and again at the school-house where they are laid out and lists of identification marks are tacked to the walls.

More than 300 unknown victims await a mass funeral unless relatives can identify and bury them in family plots.

The number of persons waiting at the graves has become larger each day.

Many citizens of Hue have tried to believe their relatives were taken away by the Viet Cong to serve

as soldiers, laborers or just to be indoctrinated for the Communist cause. Now they know that the Viet Cong meant death.^{34/}

The search parties which found these mass graves in the spring of 1969 were aided in their search by information provided by former members of the Viet Cong forces or political infrastructure who had been captured or had defected from the National Liberation Front under the Government of Viet-Nam's pacification and amnesty programs and who knew either by hearsay or, in some cases, actual experience of the mass killings. Their information was given precision by villagers in the vicinity of the execution sites, who in some cases had been pressed into service to dig the burial trenches and who had in some instances witnessed or heard the sounds of the executions, but who had hesitated to come forward previously with their information for fear of reprisal by the Communist underground against themselves or their families.

In at least two instances, specific sites were pointed out by former captives who had managed to slip their bonds and escape under cover of darkness as Communist cadre prepared to execute them with other captives to whom they were tied. Nguyen Tan Chau, an ARVN medical corpsman, was captured by the Communists

^{34/} Horst Faas, "The Massacre at Hue," dispatch to the Associated Press, April 12, 1969.

as he visited with his family over the Tet holiday and marched eastward with some thirty other prisoners, tied together in groups of ten. As they paused for a rest several kilometers from Hue, Chau managed to slip from his bonds and escape in the darkness. Later from a hiding place some distance away he watched as his fellow captives were tied back-to-back, shot, and pushed into a trench they had dug.

Phan Duy, 26, an official in a village near Hue, was also captured by the Communists early in their Tet offensive and brought with other captives to a house near a pagoda somewhere east of the city. As the Communists began to withdraw from the area, Duy became aware that a large number of captives held in other houses were disappearing. Late in February 1968 his VC captors told him and some thirty other prisoners that they were to be escorted to a nearby stream where they would be permitted to wash. They were told not to bring along their clothing and personal belongings as these would not be needed. The column was marched instead to a slit trench that local villagers had been required to dig in the sandy wastes about 300 meters from the pagoda and the prisoners were told to get into the trench and kneel down. Duy, who happened to be at the end of the line, managed to unfasten the bonds behind his back and

escape to the cover of a small strip of jungle growth nearby. The VC guards fired after him, giving him a slight flesh wound, but he escaped. Later he too listened from a distance as his fellow-prisoners were executed.

The incident of Medical Corpsman Chau occurred near Vinh Luu. That of Phan Duy near the head of the sand strip close by the village of Xuan O. These men had not known the exact area where they had so nearly escaped death, but when taken to these places by District authorities a year later, they recognized familiar landmarks and were able to point out the precise location of the burial trenches, long since obscured by drifting sands and rain, where their companions met death.^{35/} Indeed, Mr. Duy was present as the bodies of his former fellow-captives were exhumed.^{36/}

^{35/} Press briefing by Le Ba Trung, Chief, Phu Vang District, at Ngoc Anh Village, Phu Vang District, March 27, 1969.

^{36/} Horst Faas, dispatch to Associated Press, April 12, 1969, cited previously.